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Kyle, here are the "Next Steps" I'd recommend you focus on first to achieve your goals and enhance your brain health:

Phase 1/ IMMEDIATE STEPS:
- TESTS.
- We ordered blood tests. Please get these done at Lab Corp or Quest. (the ones that you have not had done in the last year, and send the ones you had done, to my assistant). Please find out how much insurance will cover BEFORE getting these tests, because some insurances will only cover tests ordered by an in-network provider. At the very least, I would like CBC, CMP, vitamin D, iron panel, thyroid, DHEA, sex hormones done.
- Please get the sleep apnea test scheduled through any sleep clinic/ department that accepts your insurance. Please fill out the sleep scales sent to you (to submit to the sleep clinic to get the test scheduled).

- MEDICATION: Medication management is the standard of care. Informed consent was obtained, after addressing risks, benefits, potential side effects that are likely to influence your decision. A good website to get this information from, is the website of the US National library of medicine, National Institutes of Health. https://druginfo.nlm.nih.gov/drugportal/
- You were informed about the off-label use of medications I have recommended/ prescribed.
- If your insurance does not cover a medication, get the free GoodRx app (often, prices out of pocket are cheaper than through insurance). You can also go to https://costplusdrugs.com, which was launched in 2022 by Mark Cuban.
FIXED TIMINGS OF MEDICATIONS: SET ALARMS/ REMINDERS. Always take your night time medications and supplements at the time you start your wind-down routine (an hour before your desired bed time).
START: Pristiq 50mg every morning.
START: Gabapentin (Neurontin) 300-900mg, 1 to 3 x daily as needed for anxiety.

- SUPPLEMENTS: Please look at label information for risk and potential side-effects prior to use. For Swanson vitamins, www.swanson.com, and for BrainMD supplements, go to www.brainmd.com/chicago

- For a 15% discount from BrainMD, use the code CHICAGO15.

- BRAIN HEALTH: Brain and Body Power Max - 2 packets per day for 2 weeks. THEN 1 packet per day AND add Omega-3 power (Total fish oil needs to be a combined EPA + DHA >3000mg daily)
- Magnesium GLYCINATE. You could do chewables (deep sleep, relaxation) 300mg at night AND 300mg in the morning and afternoon as needed (from BrainMD or Swanson Vitamins).
- L-Theanine (relaxation, focus) 200mg daily (every morning). Then after 2 weeks, consider increasing to 300mg daily.
- Ashwagandha (stress, adrenals) 600-1200mg, three times a day OR JUST AT NIGHT (from Jarrow OR from Havasu nutrition).
- Brahmi bacopa 950mg every morning.
- Craving control: from brainMD (3 caps twice daily)

Phase 2 and general brain health:
- ORGANIZATION: Please work on structuring your days (ESPECIALLY unstructured time) like we discussed. Structure is KEY. SET MULTIPLE ALARMS/REMINDERS FOR: a fixed wake up time, fixed meal times, fixed exercise times, fixed times for medications/ supplements, with leaving other slots for chores, appointments, social things.

- NUTRITION: FIXED MEAL TIMES: Set alarms.
AT THE VERY LEAST: High protein, greens. Minimize carbs, and sugar and processed foods. Choose grass-fed meat.
Please ensure adequate fluid intake, at least eight 8-ounce glasses, which equals about 2 liters, or half a gallon daily. This is called the 8 X 8 rule and is very easy to remember.

- MEDITATION: Set an alarm. Fixed time (morning or winding-down before bed).
Daily meditation for as little as 15 minutes a day, can show measurable increases in grey-matter in the frontal lobes and hippocampus, and reduced grey-matter in the amygdala (which correlates with less stress).
The Headspace app also has 'SleepCasts' which are stories that help you drift into sleep. The 'Calm' app, the "10% Happier" app, and the 'breathe to relax' app are some of my favorites. See what you

prefer and stick to it.

- SLEEP: Let's work on getting 7.5 hours a night. (5 sleep cycles, each cycle is 90 minutes).
7.30am: FIXED wake up time. Set an alarm AND GET OUT OF BED. If you tend to feel groggy in the morning, get some sunlight for 20 mins, have a glass of warm water, do deep breathing (30 full, slow, deep breaths) and jumping jacks or stretches.
For DINNER, minimize fast carbs/ sugars. Sweet potatoes, carrots (slow carbs) and kombucha are ok.
11pm: (1 hour before bedtime): Wind-down before bed (DIM LIGHTS, wear sunglasses indoors, scheduled worry time, scheduled to-do lists, nightly treasure hunt, meditation, boring reading, warm shower, sauna, hyperbaric oxygen, etc.)
12am: OR LATER: Only get to bed when sleepy, if possible, sleep on your NON-DOMINANT SIDE.
- When you are working late (till 3am), wake up at 7.30am the next day, and schedule a 3 hour nap that afternoon (instead of sleeping in).

- EXERCISE: FIXED exercise TIME: Set an alarm.
MODERATE intensity exercise for 30 mins, 5-7 times per week as a baseline. The simplest way, is to use a stationary bicycle or elliptical or treadmill, or even brisk walking, as if you are running late.

- SUBSTANCE USE: need to be completely avoided/ minimized.

Phase 3/ FUTURE CONSIDERATIONS:
- Please continue to work with other providers on your treatment team, as each has a role to play.

- There is a big difference between over thinking and problem solving.
- There is a big difference between catastrophizing and contingency planning.
- Success, your purpose is the journey, the process of self-discovery and self-improvement.

- Focus on the PROCESS, the outcomes will follow.

- First identify negative thoughts. THEN: Remember to: Ask yourself 'does this thought help or harm me? Does this thought save me or sabotage me? Does this thought help me achieve my stated goals

or make me feel stuck? Is this the chump or the champ?' REJECT what harms you. REJECT what does is not consistent with your goals/ values. REJECT what the chump says because you know he is a liar. SAY 'SHUT UP CHUMP'.

- One of my favorite psychologists, Jordan Peterson, who is a visiting professor at Harvard, has some very insightful videos on YouTube, where he blends psychology, philosophy, dreams and life coaching seamlessly to apply to the current state of our lives and the world in general. Definitely worth listening to him (Though it may not be for everybody). He also has a best-selling book '12 rules for life, an antidote to chaos.'

- Please practice the task organization skills we discussed. There are 4 types of tasks. Divide a paper into 4 parts (quadrants), and in each part write the following:
1. Urgent AND important (these are the things you have to DO ASAP.
2. Not urgent AND important (these are the things you plan, put in your calendar or FocusMate.
3. Urgent BUT not important (for example, if Facebook reminds you it is somebodys birthday). DISCARD until you do 1 and 2.
4. Not urgent BUT not important (for example, checking your phone multiple times an hour). DISCARD.

- To be held accountable, and overcome procrastination, a website www.focusmate.com matches users for free, with other users who have a specific time and date to work on an assignment, and you hold each other accountable.

- Consider the book/ online program 'Getting Things Done' by David Allen. https://gettingthingsdone.com/

- I'm looking forward to re-connecting with you in around 4 weeks to see how you're doing on these initial steps, answer any questions that have arisen, and to work with you over the next 9-12 months to create the scaffold that will get you to that next level of brain health, functioning, and fulfillment. All communications are handled by my assistant at drcreadoasst@amenclinic.com.
You can also call the Chicago clinic at 224 804 9220.

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- It was a real pleasure meeting you today, Kyle!